

Van der Weyden, Bosch and Bruegel the Elder

With the exception of van Eyck, Rogier van der Weyden (c.1400–64) was the most influential painter of his day, famed internationally for his naturalism, detail and expression. In 1435, he was made painter to the city of Brussels, but he also painted for the Church and the rulers of Burgundy, Ferrara and Florence.

Hieronymus Bosch (c.1450–1516) became extremely popular for his large, fantastic landscapes that graphically illustrated moral and religious concepts. Little is known about his life, but he was born Jeroen van Aken in Hertogenbosch in the Netherlands. His paintings are explicit renditions of contemporary concerns, particularly related to human morality.

One of the greatest 16th-century northern artists, Pieter Bruegel (c.1525–69) pioneered genre painting. A highly educated Flemish painter and printmaker, he became known for his landscapes and satirical peasant scenes full of anecdotal detail. His expressive, witty focus on the poor was unusual in art.



Bosch, *The Garden of Earthly Delights*, c.1490–1510